

Michigan State University
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Research Interests

Urban Economics, Industrial Organization, Environmental Economics

Education

Ph.D. Economics, Michigan State University	(exp.) 2027
M.A. Economics, Michigan State University	2023
B.S. & B.A. Econ., Poli. Sci., & Spanish, University of Tulsa	2021

Job Market Paper

"Price Check: Mobile Broadband and Consumer Price Response"

Consumers are increasingly sorting into different consumption "silos," devoting larger portions of their spending to household-specific products. Previous work suggests that Internet use should hasten this sorting, as advertisers leverage greater data availability to target ads and other interventions, keeping consumers in their silos. In this paper, I explore how smartphone access contributed to changes in consumer sorting. After using random forests to create the first public, national dataset on mobile Internet (3G) rollout, I demonstrate that being able to use smartphones while shopping shifts purchasing towards smaller brands and actually offsets "siloeing" by inducing greater consumer experimentation. I next estimate demand for beer, toilet paper, and other products to better understand market changes from 2007 to 2017. Demand estimation results show that smartphones shrink price elasticities but do not generally affect brand relevance. Better product matches should improve consumer welfare, though firm knowledge of consumer preferences could capture these improvements as profit. I ultimately conclude that the introduction of smartphones leads to a significant increase in consumer welfare.

Working Papers

"Out of Bounds: An Examination of Portland, OR's Urban Growth Boundary" [\[LINK\]](#)

"Trip-taking and Amenity Exposure" (w/ [Andrew Earle](#)) [\[SSRN\]](#)

"Where to Next? Mobile Broadband and Business Dynamics" [\[LINK\]](#)

Work in Progress

"The Micro-Geography of Productivity, Density, and Sorting" (w/ [Oren Ziv](#))

Peer-Reviewed Publications (Beyond Economics)

Kumar, V. S., Okeke, C. J. P., Goodfellow, G. C., [Reaves, J. T.](#), Barrick, L. W., Khalil, L. A., & Kaufman, D. I. (2026). "How Reliable and Reproducible Is Optical Coherence Tomography in Idiopathic Intracranial Hypertension? When Agreement Deteriorates in Advanced Papilledema." *Journal of Neuro-Ophthalmology*, Forthcoming. Accessible [here](#).

[Reaves, John](#), Hope O. Akaeze, Holli A. Schlakebir, Steven R. Miller, Henry O. Akaeze, and Jamie Heng-Chieh Wu. "More Care, More Workers? Gauging the Impact of Child Care Access on Labor Force Participation." *MDPI Social Sciences*, July 2025. Accessible [here](#).

Zhang, Huiwen Helen, Steven Buchele, Devin P. Raine, [John T. Reaves](#), & Mark Brennen VanderVeen. "Applying Transreading in Teaching Literaturphilosophie: Laozi, Kierkegaard, Nietzsche, and Olav H. Hauge." Chapter in *Handbook of Research on Multilingual and Multicultural Perspectives on Higher Education and Implications for Teaching*, 2022. Information accessible [here](#).

Reaves, John, Timothy Flavin, Bhaskar Mitra, Mahantesh K, and Vidhyashree Nagaraju. "Assessment And Application of EEG: A Literature Review." *Journal of Applied Bioinformatics & Computational Biology*, July 2021. Accessible [here](#).

Conference/Policy Publications

Movassaghi A., Karve Z., Calpey J., Reaves J., Childers J.T., Lack B.T., Lubert J., Sabesan V.J. "Cost-Effectiveness of Surgical Treatment Options for Massive Rotator Cuff Tears." *Poster presentation, Shoulder360 Annual Meeting*. Apr. 2026. [Top 10 Poster Award.]

Flavin, Timothy, Thomas Steiner, John Reaves, Julian Abhari, Zoe Delap, Bhaskar Mitra, and Vidhyashree Nagaraju. "ML Democracy: An Enhanced Voting Algorithm for Model Selection for Efficient EEG Data Assessment." *21st IEEE International Conference on Machine Learning and Applications (ICMLA)*, 2022. Accessible [here](#).

Hendricks, Matthew D., John Reaves, and Gary Watts. "Understanding the Impact of the Five Lagging Chargeables in Oklahoma's State Aid Formula and Policy Implications." *Institute for the Study of Education Finance*, Sept. 2020. Accessible [here](#).

Selected Technical Reports

Reaves, J. & Pierce, S. J. "Predicting COMLEX-USA Level 2-CE Score Class of 2027." [Recurring monthly report and individual-level predictions prepared for College of Osteopathic Medicine, Michigan State University]. Center for Statistical Training and Consulting, Michigan State University, 2026.

Reaves, J. & Pierce, S. J. "Clinical performance competency assessment, Class of 2026." [Report prepared for College of Osteopathic Medicine, Michigan State University]. Center for Statistical Training and Consulting, Michigan State University, 2025.

Carlson, John S., John Reaves, Steven J. Pierce, Sarina Roschmann, Skye Taylor, and Erin Werth. "Michigan Department of Health and Human Services Statewide Wraparound Evaluation." [Report prepared for Michigan Department of Health and Human Services]. Center for Statistical Training and Consulting, Michigan State University, 2025.

Teaching

Instructor, PPL 802 — Quantitative Methods in Public Policy II	SP24
Instructor, EC 201 — Introduction to Microeconomics	SU23
TA, EC 450 — Environmental Economics	FA26
TA, EC 499 — Senior Seminar	FA26
TA, EC 201 — Introduction to Microeconomics	FA22-FA23, FA24, FA25
TA, EC 301 — Intermediate Microeconomics	SP22, FA26
TA, EC 302 — Intermediate Macroeconomics	FA21

Conference Presentations

2026: Midwest Economics Association, MSU Grand River Conference
2025: MSU Grand River Conference, Urban Economics Association, Southern Economics Association
2024: MSU Red Cedar Conference, Urban Economics Association, Southern Economics Association (coauthor presenting)
2023: MSU Graduate Student Seminar (internal), National Tax Association (poster session)

Research Experience

RA, Center for Statistical Training and Consulting (CSTAT) MSU	2025-2026
RA, Antonio Galvao (short-term) MSU	2025
RA, Jamie Wu & Steven Miller (CEPR) MSU	2023-2024
RA, Vidhyashree Nagaraju (Computer Science) University of Tulsa	2020-2021
RA, Matthew Hendricks (Economics) University of Tulsa	Summer 2020

Service

Interdisciplinary Inquiry and Teaching (IIT) Fellowship MSU	2024-2025
Graduate Micro Tutoring MSU	2022-2024
Graduate Student (First-Year) Mentor MSU	2022-2024
Graduate Employees Union (GEU) Steward MSU	2022-2024
Economics Graduate Student Organization Representative MSU	2022-2023

Informational Seminars

HPCC Introductory Session (w/ Maitri Punjabi)	Fall 2025
"An Introduction to Causal Inference for Observational Studies" (CSTAT)	Spring 2025
Economics Department R Coding Boot Camp	Fall 2023

Proficiencies

Software: R/RStudio, LaTeX, Git/Github, Tableau, Python, Stata
Languages: English (native), Spanish (working)

References

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